
*UCLA MS graduation of Krishna's son Aswath*

him to be more agile than ever before, and attentive and receptive more than he had ever been in his life. "The belief that you can be as good as anybody just by doing things differently has stood by me for my entire life. The thought has always helped me find solutions to even the most difficult of problems," says Krishna.

## It's about India

Leaving behind everything including your peers and the work you have done during the last two decades is challenging. But embarking on a journey that will require more from you than what you have done in the past is certainly a peril of a task. Krishna knew he was landing himself in a world full of new challenges while accepting a job in the private sector and starting his innings with National Semiconductor as their director of engineering.

"Stepping into a multinational company meant meeting expectations which were set pretty high. It was definitely a challenge. But the biggest of challenges bring along the biggest of opportunities," says Krishna. He adds, "I was not working on semiconductor designs full time, and the new responsibility required me to work on the same more than on anything else."

But Krishna seemed to have already prepared for the task ahead in order to stay on the front of the curve by attending a diploma course from Indian Institute of Science (IISc). He got the diploma in IC Design at a time of his career when most others were busy enjoying the perks of their professional life. Krishna's hunger for knowledge, knowingly or unknowingly, had helped him in preparing for the future.

"IISc had a collaboration programme with University of Delft back then, and under this collaboration they were running a semiconductor design course, and as I was encouraged to attend the same, I did," remembers Krishna.

Krishna devoted more than 16 hours a day to his new innings with National Semiconductor for the first six months. He says this much time was needed to learn about the semiconductor design in advanced technology nodes, and as he had joined an organisation that was way ahead on the curve, he wanted to make sure that he proved to be an asset to them.

"The technology you can understand quickly but the technique and practices is what takes time to develop. The tools and methodologies I was assigned at National Semiconductor were entirely different from what I had done at BEL. Understanding all these tools and their capabilities was the biggest challenge, a challenge that awarded me with knowledge that is a gift for a lifetime," he says.

He adds, "I met some of the brightest minds from India and from the world at National Semiconductor. As a team we were able to produce extraordinary results, and National Semiconductor's India team grew from 30 to more than 100. As a major accomplishment I also saw National Semiconductor establish an R&D lab (NS Labs) outside the United States, and this lab was established in India."

Krishna was promoted as the Managing Director of National Semiconductor's India Design Center in August 2005, and this lab was established in India around 2008. This was probably one of the first research labs in semiconductor from a biggie like National Semiconductor in the country.

It was in December 2011 that Krishna's innings with Rambus Chip Technologies started in India. He had joined the company in the capacity of MD for its India Design Center. Rambus Technologies in 2015 promoted Krishna to the ranks of Corporate Vice President. "From designing systems in BEL to semiconductor chips in National Semiconductor to high-end IP development in Rambus, it was a journey that helped me to touch all aspects of Electronics System Design & Manufacturing (ESDM) very closely. Learning at Rambus was immense. Rambus is a company that always developed IPs which the world needed 2-3 years later. They set the new future specifications and built IPs for those specs which then become the de-facto industry standard in course of time. Rubbing shoulders with the thought leaders in some of the technologies that are used widely today was memorable," says Krishna.

In the same year, 2015, when he became the VP at Rambus, he also got selected to be the Vice Chairman of IESA, the organisation that he is the CEO & President of today. Krishna was the Chairman of IESA in 2016 as well. He had been in touch with IESA since his working with National Semiconductor days, which gave him a chance to contribute to the cause of IESA as a full-time member.

Krishna and the team at National Semiconductor were also responsible for establishing the first advanced VLSI lab at IIT Kharagpur along with collaboration with a couple of other leading MNC companies. As the industry started reaping benefits of the advanced VLSI lab in the form of much more capable engineers coming out whom they wanted to hire, Krish-